

3.6 Playing Director

Not all the fun of digital video lies in watching! After all, as the cameras in phones get better, and the market penetration of digital cameras soar, people are fast becoming directors in their own little movie worlds!

So whether it's making a video CD out of your still photographs, or editing a home-movie that you shot yourself, a digital camera, a PC and a CD-writer is all you need to make your own movie and send it to your friends and family!

A large population of our readers run Windows XP on their systems, and as a result, have Windows Movie Maker pre-installed. Unfortunately, most of us don't realise the power that this little "free" software has. Let's learn more about Movie Maker:

The first step is to get the latest version of Microsoft's Windows Movie Maker from the windows update site. Visit <http://go.microsoft.com/?linkid=3646727> to update your Windows installation and get the latest version of Movie Maker. If you have a decent Internet connection and have Automatic Updates enabled on Windows XP, you probably will not need to update your version of Movie Maker.

Before you begin shooting or editing your movie, you need to make sure you have a decent system, capable of editing video. The minimum recommended system configuration is as follows:

- m 1.5 GHz CPU
- m Windows XP + SP2
- m 256 MB RAM
- m 64 MB video memory with 3D graphics acceleration
- m Support for DirectX 9
- m 4 GB free hard disk space
- m CD-Writer or DVD-Writer drive
- m Sound card + speakers or headphones
- m Internet connection